

Bank of Leeds Investment Proposal (2026)

Gleadless Valley Regeneration Programme

A Targeted Housing, Public Realm and Transport Investment Strategy

Prepared for:

Bank of Leeds

Urban Regeneration & Community Investment Division

Date

2026

Programme Value

£32.5 Million

Executive Summary

The Bank of Leeds proposes a **£32.5 million co-investment programme** to support the ongoing regeneration of Gleadless Valley. Rather than attempting to fund a complete redevelopment of the estate or construct an entirely new tram line, the programme is designed as a catalyst for wider public and private investment.

The Bank would provide commercial finance alongside Sheffield City Council, housing associations, developers and government regeneration funds, targeting projects that improve quality of life, stimulate private investment and enhance connectivity.

The proposal is based on three principles:

- Improve existing neighbourhoods rather than wholesale redevelopment.
 - Unlock future transport improvements through early design and land safeguarding.
 - Increase private investment through targeted commercial lending.
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Strategic Vision

Create one of Sheffield's most attractive suburban communities by combining:

- refurbished housing,
- improved neighbourhood centres,
- upgraded parks,

- better transport,
- stronger local businesses.

The objective is not to transform Gleadless Valley overnight, but to create a programme that encourages sustained investment over the next decade.

Investment Programme

Project	Investment
Housing improvements	£10.0m
Tram extension feasibility & safeguarded works	£4.0m
Abbeydale Road tram corridor design	£2.5m
Commercial centre improvements	£4.5m
Parks & public realm	£3.5m
Community facilities	£2.5m
Property acquisition & regeneration fund	£3.0m
Programme management & contingency	£2.5m

Total Investment

£32.5 Million

1. Housing Renewal

Investment

£10 Million

The focus is on improving existing homes rather than large-scale demolition.

Programme includes:

- external insulation,
- new roofs,
- replacement windows,
- environmental improvements,
- refurbishment of vacant properties,
- improvements to communal areas.

Estimated homes benefiting:

300–400 properties

2. Future Tram Extension

Investment

£4 Million

Rather than constructing a tram extension immediately, the proposal funds the preparatory work required for a future scheme.

This includes:

- route design,
- engineering studies,
- land safeguarding,
- utility surveys,
- planning applications,
- bridge and junction assessments.

Preferred long-term alignment:

Gleadless Townend

↓

Raeburn Road

↓

Gleadless Valley Centre

↓

Gaunt Shops

By completing this work now, Sheffield would be in a stronger position to seek future regional transport funding.

3. Abbeydale Road Corridor

Investment

£2.5 Million

Commission a comprehensive transport study for a potential tram or bus rapid transit corridor serving:

- London Road,
- Abbeydale Road,
- Heeley,
- Meersbrook,

- Gleadless Valley.

Funding would cover:

- transport modelling,
- feasibility studies,
- concept designs,
- business case preparation.

No construction is assumed within this programme.

4. Local Shopping Centres

Investment

£4.5 Million

Refurbish existing neighbourhood shopping areas.

Projects include:

- new shopfronts,
- public squares,
- improved lighting,
- upgraded paving,
- business grants,
- CCTV,
- improved accessibility.

The aim is to attract additional independent businesses and improve the appearance of local centres.

5. Parks & Public Realm

Investment

£3.5 Million

Enhance the Valley's existing green spaces through:

- resurfaced footpaths,
- new play areas,
- tree planting,
- seating,
- sports facilities,
- outdoor fitness equipment,
- biodiversity improvements.

6. Community Investment

Investment

£2.5 Million

Support local facilities including:

- community hubs,
 - youth activities,
 - adult learning spaces,
 - health and wellbeing initiatives,
 - enterprise support programmes.
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7. Property Regeneration Fund

Investment

£3 Million

The Bank of Leeds establishes a revolving property fund to acquire and refurbish vacant commercial premises and selected residential properties for resale or lease.

The objective is to encourage further private investment while generating a modest financial return.

Financial Model

Commercial Property

Investment:

£3 million

Expected value after refurbishment:

£3.8–4.2 million

Estimated rental income:

Approximately

£250,000 per year

Housing Improvements

Although the programme does not directly build new homes, refurbishment is expected to increase neighbourhood desirability and support local property values.

Illustrative uplift in refurbished areas:

5–10% over the medium term, subject to wider market conditions.

Employment

Construction

Approximately

120 temporary jobs

Permanent employment

Sector	Jobs
Retail & local services	40
Community facilities	25
Property management	15

Total

Approximately 80 permanent jobs

Wider Economic Impact

The programme is expected to:

- improve neighbourhood confidence,
- reduce vacancy rates,
- support local retailers,
- encourage private housing investment,
- prepare the area for future transport improvements.

Estimated additional annual local economic activity:

£4–6 Million

Funding Structure

Source	Amount
Bank of Leeds	£15.0m
Sheffield City Council	£7.5m
Housing associations	£5.0m
Private developers & grants	£5.0m

Delivery Programme

Phase One (2026–2027)

- housing refurbishment,
- commercial centre improvements,
- property acquisitions.

Investment:

£15 million

Phase Two (2027–2028)

- parks,
- community facilities,
- transport feasibility work.

Investment:

£10 million

Phase Three (2028–2030)

- completion of public realm works,
- business support,
- preparation of future tram business cases.

Investment:

£7.5 million

Investment Thesis

This proposal is intentionally modest and realistic. Rather than attempting to fund a complete transformation of Gleadless Valley, the **£32.5 million programme** is designed to unlock larger future investment.

By improving existing housing, strengthening local shopping centres, enhancing public spaces and preparing the groundwork for future transport schemes, the Bank of Leeds can help create conditions that attract additional public funding and private development.

The proposal recognises that successful regeneration is often delivered through a sequence of well-targeted investments rather than a single large capital project. It therefore positions the Bank as a long-term partner in the area's renewal while maintaining a scale of investment that is proportionate to the current economic and funding environment.